

Kino Watanabe

kw3180@cumc.columbia.edu | github.com/kinowatanabe/

Education

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

New York, NY

Master of Science in Epidemiology. GPA: 4.08.

2024 – 2026

Relevant Coursework: Data Science I, Applied Regression I, Principles of Epidemiology I, Epidemiology II: Design and Conduct of Observational Epi Studies, Analysis of Categorical Data, Application of Epi Research Methods, Epidemiology III: Applied Epidemiologic Analysis, Psychiatric Epidemiology, Spatial Epidemiology.

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON

Seattle, WA

Bachelor of Science in Biology, Physiology.

2017 – 2022

Dean's List: Winter 2019, Spring 2020, Annual Dean's List 2020-2021, Autumn 2022, Spring 2022.

Technical Skills

Skills: R, SAS, Excel, REDCap, EHR systems, data wrangling, data visualization, statistical analysis.

Projects

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

New York, NY

Master's Thesis

May 2026

Epidemiology of Suicide by Jumping From a Height in the United States Between 2016-2023

- Conducted a cross-sectional analysis by estimating characteristics and correlates of jumping suicides, state-level rates and its changes over time, and correlates of injury sites of jumping in the National Violent Death Reporting System.
- Identified correlates of jumping suicide and injury sites of jumping with logistic regression.
- Estimated state-level changes over time for rates of jumping suicide with Poisson regression.
- Created data visualizations and heat maps in R.

Data Science I Project

Dec 2025

Unmasking Variables: A Descriptive Analysis of Gun Violence Correlates in New York City

- Explored how green spaces are potentially associated with firearm incidents in Manhattan, NYC, for a cross-sectional project.
- Geocoded firearm incidents and park spaces from NYC Open Data.
- Built interactive maps of firearm incidents and park acreage in R to examine spatial patterns.

Research and Teaching Experience

COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY

New York, NY

Graduate-level TA (Epidemiology I, Epidemiology II, SAS)

Aug 2025 – May 2026

- Led a weekly discussion section for 29 students, lecturing foundational concepts and facilitating course materials in EPIDP6400 Principles of Epidemiology I from Aug-Dec 2025.
- Assisted 300 students across EPIDP8438 Epidemiology II and EPIDP8483 Application of Epidemiologic Research Methods (SAS course) from Jan-May 2026.
- Taught epidemiology and SAS concepts through in-person support, weekly office hours, assignment feedbacks, and exam reviews.

Summer Health Professions Education Program (SHPEP) Facilitator

May 2025 – July 2025

- Served as Teaching Assistant for Anatomy and Physiology and Statistics for a healthcare pathway program at Columbia University Vagelos College of Physicians and Surgeons.
- Led discussion sessions 2x a week for 50 students to reinforce course concepts, preparing them for success in future pre-med classes.

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- Advocated for and mentored undergraduate students who are economically disadvantaged and/or identify with groups that have been historically underrepresented within the health professions.

Course Note-Taker for Office of Disability Services

Sept 2024 – Dec 2024

- Provided accurate and comprehensive notes for EPID8421 Introduction to Psychiatry for Epidemiology and Global Mental Health, ensuring equitable access to education.
- Demonstrated ability to synthesize and present information in a timely and effective manner.

UW SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Seattle, WA

RECOVER Research Coordinator at Chu Lab

May 2023 – June 2024

- Responsible for the day-to-day operations for a longitudinal, cohort study of post-acute sequelae of COVID-19 at varying stages of infection.
- Managed longitudinal clinical and survey data for more than 200 participants, including recording study data, collecting biospecimens, and facilitating clinical assessments and survey-triggered tests.
- Gained a wide breadth of knowledge about clinical tests: NIH Toolbox Cognitive Battery, Pulmonary Function Test, EKG, Smell Test, 6 Minute Walk Test, Vision Test, Home Polysomnography.
- Managed adverse event/serious adverse event, clinical/abnormal lab result, and suicide ideation reporting.
- Extracted data from electronic medical records.
- Utilized multiple data-capture platforms such as REDCap, electronic health records, and OnCore.

HAARVI Research Coordinator at Chu Lab

Dec 2022 – June 2024

- Conducted clinical visits to study the immune response to SARS-CoV-2, Influenza, and RSV infections and vaccinations.
- Collected biospecimens (blood, nasal, saliva, and breath samples) and study data regarding vaccinations, infections, and post-infection surveys for more than 500 participants and 30 publications.
- Designed study timelines and protocols, specific to each sub-study.
- Expanded and developed the study to include Influenza/RSV samples and a pediatric cohort.
- Maintained electronic data collection system while considering data security and adhering to HIPAA.

SEATTLE CHILDREN'S RESEARCH INSTITUTE

Seattle, WA

Laboratory Technician, Volunteer

Nov 2022 – May 2023

- Genotyped mice specimens to assist Dr. Allison Hanaford with her investigation of the role of immunometabolism in mitochondrial disease.
- Mastered wet lab techniques, such as assembling PCR reactions, processing samples, running agarose gel electrophoresis, and analyzing amplified DNA.

UW SCHOOL OF MEDICINE

Seattle, WA

Chu Lab Aide

Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

- Oversaw lab operation duties for Dr. Helen Chu's lab, who conducts large-scale community-based studies of respiratory virus transmission and clinical trials of vaccines and therapeutics.

HCT Research Assistant

Sept 2021 – June 2023

- Administered and collected nasal swabs for Husky Coronavirus Testing, a study in the Department of Medicine: Allergy and Infectious Diseases with Dr. Helen Chu.
- Adhered to study protocol to ensure research quality and integrity for a study with over 54,000 participants.
- Longitudinal data collection and management through RedCap and Excel.

Publications

Geng, L. N., Erlandson, K. M., Hornig, M., Letts, R., Selvaggi, C., Ashktorab, H., Atieh, O., Bartram, L., Brim, H., Brosnahan, S. B., Brown, J., Castro, M., Charney, A., Chen, P., Deeks, S. G., Erdmann, N., Flaherman, V. J., Ghamloush, M. A., Goepfert, P., Goldman, J. D., ... RECOVER Consortium (2025). 2024 Update of the RECOVER-Adult Long COVID Research Index. JAMA, 333(8), 694–700. <https://doi.org/10.1001/jama.2024.24184>

Xie, J., Chen, D. G., Chour, W., Ng, R. H., Zhang, R., Yuan, D., Choi, J., McKasson, M., Troisch, P., Smith, B., Jones, L., Webster, A., Rasheed, Y., Li, S., Edmark, R., Hong, S., Murray, K. M., Logue, J. K., Franko, N. M., Lausted, C. G., ... Watanabe K., ... Heath, J. R. (2025). APMAT analysis reveals the association between CD8 T cell receptors, cognate antigen, and T cell phenotype and persistence. Nature communications, 16(1), 1402. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-56659-3>

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Hanaford A.R., Khanna K.J., Truong V., James K., Liao R., Chen Y., Mulholland M., Kayser B., Watanabe K., Shien Hsieh E., Morgan P., Sarkar S., Kalia V., Johnson S.C. (2024). Disruption of adaptive immunity does not attenuate disease in the *Ndufs4*(-/-) model of Leigh syndrome. Under review at *Brain communications*.

Swank, Z., Borberg, E., Chen, Y., Senussi, Y., Chalise, S., Manickas-Hill, Z., Yu, X. G., Li, J. Z., Alter, G., Henrich, T. J., Kelly, J. D., Hoh, R., Goldberg, S. A., Deeks, S. G., Martin, J. N., Peluso, M. J., Talla, A., Li, X., Skene, P., Bumol, T. F., ... RECOVER consortium authors (2024). Measurement of circulating viral antigens post-SARS-CoV-2 infection in a multicohort study. *Clinical microbiology and infection : the official publication of the European Society of Clinical Microbiology and Infectious Diseases*, S1198-743X(24)00432-4. Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cmi.2024.09.001>

Erlandson, K. M., Geng, L. N., Selvaggi, C. A., Thaweethai, T., Chen, P., Erdmann, N. B., Goldman, J. D., Henrich, T. J., Hornig, M., Karlson, E. W., Katz, S. D., Kim, C., Cribbs, S. K., Laiyemo, A. O., Letts, R., Lin, J. Y., Marathe, J., Parthasarathy, S., Patterson, T. F., Taylor, B. D., ... RECOVER-Adult Cohort (2024). Differentiation of Prior SARS-CoV-2 Infection and Postacute Sequelae by Standard Clinical Laboratory Measurements in the RECOVER Cohort. *Annals of internal medicine*, 177(9), 1209–1221. <https://doi.org/10.7326/M24-0737>

Hanaford A.R., Khanna K.J., Truong V., Liao R., Chen Y., Mulholland M., Kayser B., Watanabe K., Shien Hsieh E., Sedensky M., Morgan P., Kalia V., Sarkar S., Johnson S.C. (2023). Interferon-gamma contributes to disease progression in the *Ndufs4* (-/-) model of Leigh syndrome. *Neuropathology and applied neurobiology*, 50(3), e12977. <https://doi.org/10.1111/nan.12977>

Awards

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON AWARD OF EXCELLENCE	2024
Distinguished Staff Award for Impact (HAARVI Study Team)	
UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON LAB SAFETY AWARDS	2023
Top Dawgs in Safety (Department of Allergy & Infectious Disease, School of Medicine)	
UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON AWARD OF EXCELLENCE	2023
Distinguished Staff Award for Innovation (Husky Coronavirus Testing Study Team)	
UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON HOUSING AND FOOD SERVICES	2019
Rockstar Rookie	

Leadership

CITIZENS' PUBLIC HEALTH LITERACY (CIPHER) HEALTH EDUCATION LEAD	New York, NY
Developed and led 2 public health projects about digital literacy and nutrition literacy leading 2 teams (30 students).	May 2025 – May 2026

Volunteer

EPICONNECT MENTORSHIP PROGRAM	New York, NY
Connect with students, serving as a resource to ease transition into graduate school.	Aug 2025 – May 2026
CITIZENS' PUBLIC HEALTH LITERACY (CIPHER)	New York, NY
Support community-based organizations to promote mental and physical health and to empower youth through sports, leadership, tutoring, and mentoring.	Feb 2025 – Current
JAPN 1020, JAPN 2010	Remote
Edited and subtitled 32 lectures for university-level Japanese language courses.	Mar 2022 – Oct 2023